Some of the functions of Windows Operating System are:

- Access applications (programs) on the computer (word processing, games, spread sheets, calculators and so on).
- Load any new program on the computer.
- Manage hardware such as printers, scanners, mouse, digital cameras etc.,
- File management activities (For example creating, modifying, saving, deleting files and folders).
- Change computer settings such as colour scheme, screen savers of your monitor, etc.

With reference to the Table 5.1, let us see the versions of Windows Operating System.

5.3. Various versions of Windows

Versions	Logo	Year	Specific features
Windows 1.x		1985	• Introduction of GUI in 16 - bit. processor • Mouse was introduced as an input device.
Windows 2.x		1987	• Supports to minimize or maximize windows. • Control panel feature was introduced with various system settings and customising options.
Windows 3.x		1992	• Introduced the concept of multitasking. • Supported 256 colours which brought a more modern, colourful look to the interface.
Windows NT		1993	• Designed to act as servers in network.
Windows 95		1995	• Introduced Start button, the taskbar, Windows Explorer and Start menu. • Introduced 32 - bit processor and focused more on multitasking.
Windows 98		1998	• Integration of the Web browser (Internet Explorer) with the Operating System. • DOS gaming began to disappear as Windows based games improved. • Plug and play feature was introduced.
Windows Me		2000	• It introduced automated system diagnostics and recovery tools.

11th Std Computer Science_EM Chapter 5.indd 58 06-01-2023 15:06:13